

Medford School Committee
Regular Meeting - May 20, 2019
Council Chambers - 7:00 PM

- I. Roll Call and Salute the Flag
- II. Approval of Minutes of May 6, 2019
- III. Approval of Bills/Transfer of Funds and Approval of Payrolls
- IV. Report of Secretary
- V. Report of Committees
- VI. Community Participation
 - Jennifer Sawin - Styrofoam Trays
 - Sharon Hayes - ELA MCAS
 - Charlene Douglas and Members of the Medford Teachers Association
- VII. Report of Superintendent
 1. Superintendent's Updates and Comments
 2. Recognition of Medford Middle School String Ensemble - Anthony Szykniej
 3. Recommendation to Appoint Joan Bowen to Director of Pupil Services Position - Dr. Marice Edouard-Vincent
 4. Recommendation to Approve New Math Curriculum: Illustrative Math - Faiza Khan
 5. Report on Project Bread - Sarah Cluggish, Rosemarie Caward, and Holly Grace
 6. Recommendation to Approve Donation for the Jae S. Lim Science and Mathematics Prize
- Rocco Cieri
 7. Report on Medford PTO/PTGs: Annual Update

8. Report on Massachusetts General Hospital Research Initiative to Understand and Reduce Cannabis Use in Adolescents - Dr. Randi Schuster

9. Report on K-12 Assessments - Dr. Marice Edouard-Vincent

VIII. Old Business

IX. Communications

X. New Business

School Committee Resolution

RESOLUTION TO HOLD HARMLESS 2019 10th GRADE MCAS DUE TO RACIST QUESTION

Whereas: the graduation requirement makes the tenth grade MCAS exam one of the highest stakes exams most Massachusetts students take; and

Whereas: teachers, families, schools, and tax payers all invest time and resources to give students the best possible chance at success on the exam; and

Whereas: the recent 10th grade MCAS English exam contained an essay that required students to write a journal entry from the perspective of an openly racist character; and

Whereas: the Massachusetts Department of Elementary and Secondary Education (DESE) was unable to defend the question, quickly moving to not have it count; and

Whereas: we only discovered this because students had the courage to violate the rules about discussing specific MCAS questions; and

Whereas: research shows that exposure to negative stereotypes can have a negative impact on student performance; and

Whereas: the impact of the racist question on performance cannot be quantified;

now therefore be it

Resolved: that the Medford School Committee calls on DESE to exempt students who took the test with the rejected question from the graduation exam requirement; and further

Resolved: that the Medford School Committee calls for DESE to immediately implement a policy of releasing old MCAS questions, so that there can be transparency to prevent such egregious errors in the future; and further

Resolved: that a copy of this resolution be delivered to DESE, the Governor, and the Medford state and local legislative delegations and otherwise widely distributed.

School Committee Resolution

Be it resolved, that the Medford School Committee express its sincere condolences to the family of Salvatore Caraviello. Mr. Caraviello was the uncle of Medford City Councillor Richard Caraviello.

XI. Negotiations and Legal Matters

- Union Negotiations

Requested Reports:

Payroll Update (tabled 1/14/19)

Computer Science Curriculum (via email 1/17/19)

Out-of-District Students Enrolled in Medford Schools (3/6/19)

Health Policy (3/18/19)

Math MCAS - Break Down by Topic and School (3/18/19)

Science MCAS - All Items, Districts, State Scores, Broken Down by School (3/18/19)

Grants (4/1/19)

Feasibility of Student Scholarship for Landscape Design at High School (4/8/19)

Security Improvements (4/8/19)

CBA Requests (4/3/19)

Security Checklist Protocol to Begin School Year 2019-2020 (4/3/19)

Inventory of Large Equipment at All Schools (4/3/19)